APEX REPUTATION CONSULTANTS

Proving Gold Peak Is the Best Tea on the Shelf

A Communication Plan for Gold Peak Tea

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Team 096 | BCOM 314 | Prepared for the Gold Peak Director of Communications

Real tea leaves, never powder or concentrate.

Real hand-picked top leaves.

Real brewing, for a home-brewed taste.

(CSP Daily News, 2021; Tea & Coffee Trade Journal, 2025; Coca-Cola, n.d.)

So why isn't Gold Peak known as the best tea on the shelf?

Meet your Apex Reputation Consultants Team



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The tea market is shrinking, and no brand owns “best tea” yet

−1.5%

canned & bottled tea sales ($4.8B), year ending April 2026
(Circana, as cited in Alverson, 2026)

Top 3

AriZona, Pure Leaf and Gold Peak fight for the same shelf
(Alverson, 2026)

88%

of shoppers say taste is what drives their purchase
(IFIC, as cited in FoodNavigator, 2026)

OUR COMMUNICATION OBJECTIVE

By December 2027, tea drinkers name Gold Peak the best-tasting bottled tea made with real ingredients.

BACKGROUND

Gold Peak's real ingredients are an edge rivals can't match



Top leaves only

(Coca-Cola, n.d.)



Hand-picked in Sri Lanka

(Tea & Coffee Trade Journal, 2025)



Brewed, never concentrate

(CSP Daily News, 2021)



Rated 4.5–4.8★

(Walmart.com; Sam's Club, 2026)

THE GAP

This proof lives on brand pages and trade press, not in the aisle or on shoppers' phones. And "natural" alone won't cut it: 40% of shoppers think natural and organic mean the same thing. *(Acosta Group, as cited in Silverstein, 2025)*

Ingredient-conscious tea drinkers want to see what's inside



WHO THEY ARE

Health-focused shoppers, led by millennials & Gen Z, who want short ingredient lists

WHERE TO REACH THEM

Instagram (55% of women), Facebook (80% of ages 30–49), the QR code *(Pew Research Center, 2025)*

58% read labels all or most of the time *(Acosta Group, 2026)*

79% of health-focused shoppers worry about artificial ingredients *(Acosta Group, 2026)*

66% would scan an on-pack QR code for ingredients *(GS1 US, 2025)*

THEIR MESSAGE

"Naturally brewed from the top leaves. See exactly what's inside."

Everyday tea drinkers just want the best-tasting tea

WHO THEY ARE

Broad group; 87% of millennials drink tea. Not focused on labels or sugar *(Tea Association of the USA, as cited in Corner Coffee Store, 2026)*

WHERE TO REACH THEM

Grocery aisles & fountains, YouTube (84% of adults), TikTok (37%); strongest in the Southeast *(Pew Research Center, 2025; Mordor Intelligence, 2026)*

88% buy on taste first, the #1 factor
(IFIC, as cited in FoodNavigator, 2026)

61% of tea drinkers now drink ready-to-drink tea
(Mintel, 2026)

~80% of the tea Americans drink is iced
(Tea Association of the USA, as cited in Corner Coffee Store, 2026)

THEIR MESSAGE

"Tastes home-brewed, because it is. Taste the real difference."

One promise, proven two ways

> **“Gold Peak is the best tea, because it’s real.”**



INGREDIENT-CONSCIOUS

Prove it with ingredients

Show the leaves, the origin and the brewing



EVERYDAY DRINKERS

Prove it with taste

Let them taste it and see others pick it

BENCHMARK Snapple won back trust with one ingredient message, told on TV, in stores, online and on the label at once.
(MediaPost, 2009; Packaging Digest, 2015)

RECOMMENDATION 1

RealIsGold.com shows exactly what's inside, one scan away

FOR

Ingredient-conscious tea drinkers

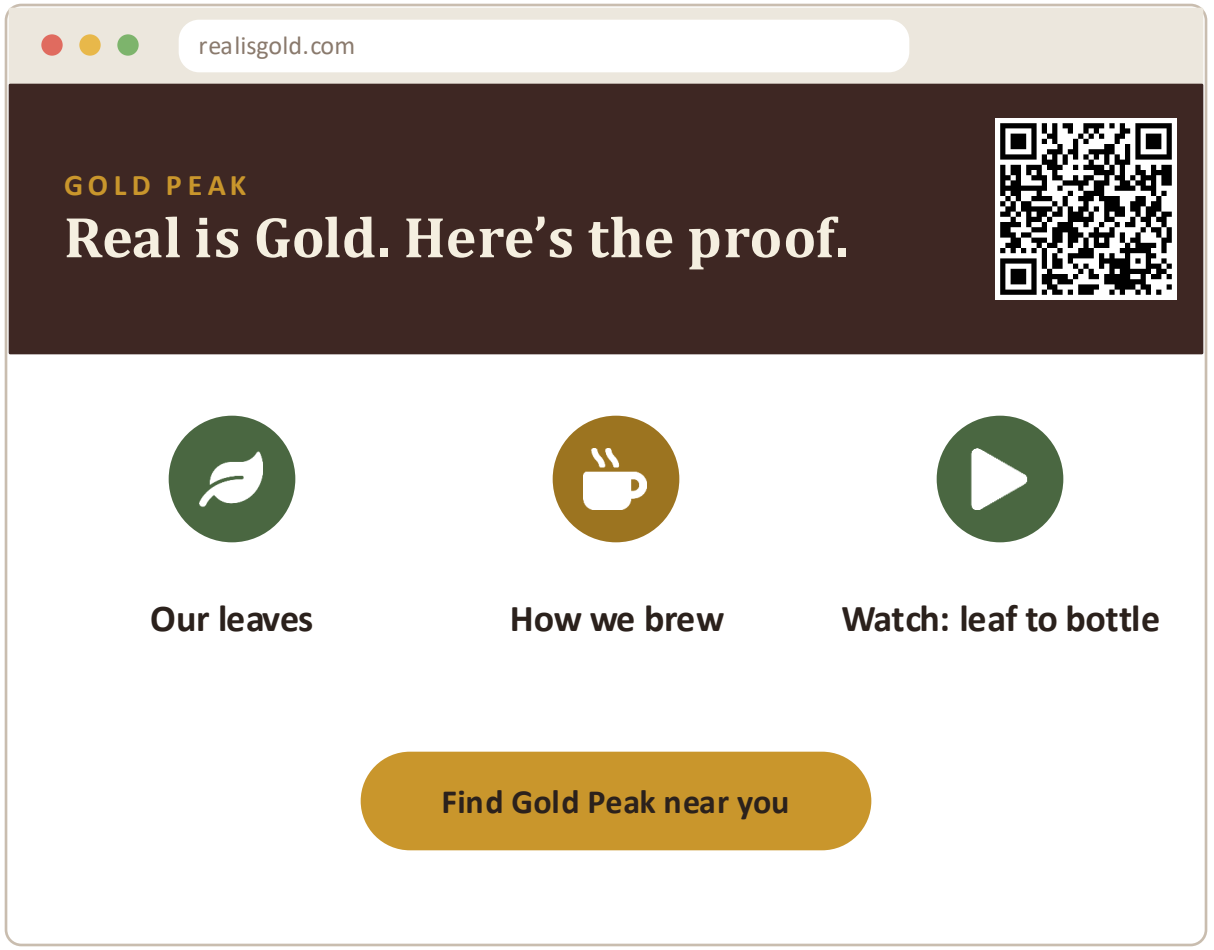
MESSAGE

"Naturally brewed from the top leaves. See exactly what's inside."

HOW WE REACH THEM

QR code already on every bottle + Instagram & Facebook ads to adults 25–49

66% would scan a QR code for ingredient details
(GS1 US, 2025)



RECOMMENDATION 2

The Real Taste Challenge lets drinkers taste the difference

FOR

Everyday tea drinkers

MESSAGE

"Tastes home-brewed, because it is. Taste the real difference."

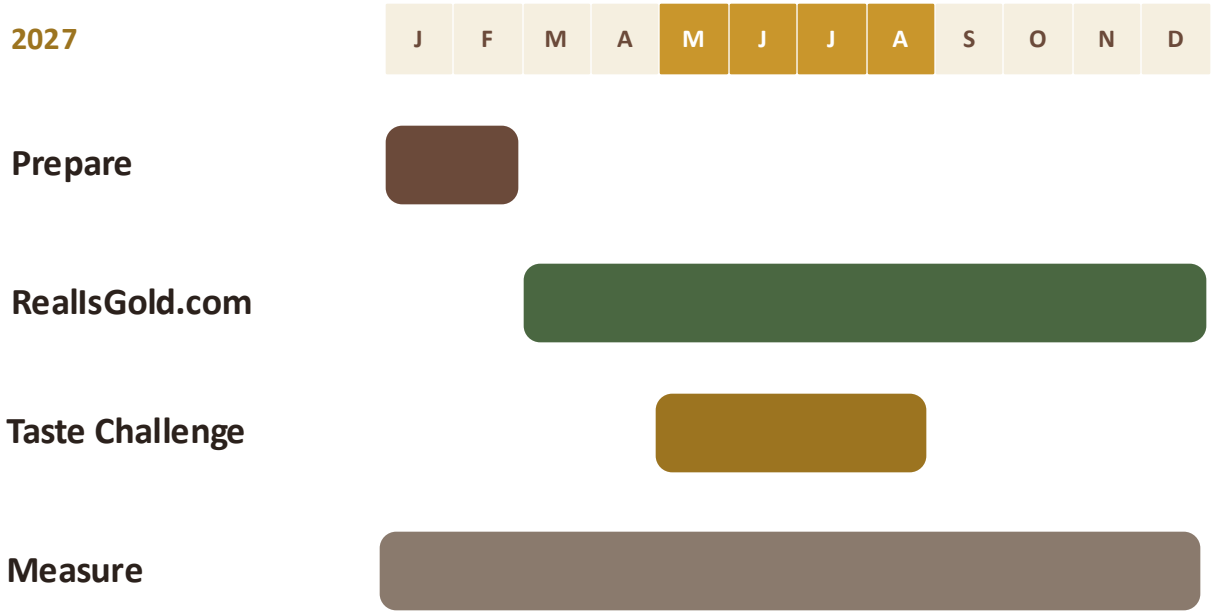
HOW WE REACH THEM

300 summer in-store sampling events (Southeast first) + 10 creator blind taste tests on YouTube & TikTok

15–35% of sampled shoppers go on to buy *(Makai, 2026)*



A $274K, 12-month rollout that peaks for summer



Summer focus: tea purchases peak in summer and early fall (Mordor Intelligence, 2026)

Budget	Cost
RealIsGold.com + video	$70,000
Real Taste Challenge	$152,000
Staff time	$52,000
TOTAL	**$274,000**

Rates: Demo Wizard (n.d.); InfluencerMarketingHub (2026); Market Intelligence Tools (2026). Other figures are ARC estimates.

How we'll know Gold Peak is winning as the best tea

300

sampling events

HOW: Vendor reports

250K

RealIsGold.com visits

HOW: Web & QR analytics

90%

social questions answered in 24 hrs

HOW: Listening tool

+10 pts

"best-tasting bottled tea"

HOW: Pre/post survey

+10 pts

"made with real ingredients"

HOW: Pre/post survey

CONCLUSION

Real leaves. Real brewing. Now, the best tea, proven.

- **Ingredient-conscious drinkers** see what's inside
- **Everyday drinkers** taste the difference
- **Gold Peak** owns "best tea" on the shelf

CALL TO ACTION

Approve the $385K plan by November 30 so RealIsGold.com launches in March and the Taste Challenge is ready for summer.

We welcome your questions.

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